In his second term, Prime Minister Narendra Modi told cabinet colleagues to slash their ministerial expenses by at least 20 per cent. He cut down personal staff at his own residence-cum-office by 50 per cent—from over fifty staffers to twenty-five—and the PMO's staff by 15 per cent.[50] Again, this idea of austerity at the top can be traced back to an older Jan Sangh focus on cutting down on wasteful expenditure. As Vajpayee said in 1971, 'our plan envisages a 10 per cent cut in Government expenditure which can easily be done if all useless foreign travels, cultural delegations and wasteful diplomatic and embassy expenditure is stopped'.[51]

The Modi government's budget in 2019 reduced income tax slab rates for those in the lowest income brackets (even though the removal of exemptions for those above that meant that while the government gave by one hand, it took from another), while increasing income tax brackets for those higher up in the food chain. The Jan Sangh had always been in favour of lower tax rates for those who earn less. For example, when S. Bhoothalingam recommended in the 1960s that annual incomes under ₹7,500 be exempt from income tax, the Jan Sangh wholeheartedly supported this idea. 'Do you know that the government is spending more money on the collection of income tax (upto Rs 7500/- bracket) than it actually realises from the assesses,' Vajpayee asked at the time. 'What is the use of having such a tax slab where the cost of collection of a tax is higher than the tax realisation. In the Public Accounts Committee [Mr Vajpayee was the Chairman of the Committee] we studied the problem and found that if incomes upto Rs 7500/- are exempted from taxation it would lead to no loss of revenues because the loss would be more than balanced by the saving in expenditure. What is more, the income tax staff and officers would be free to concentrate on the higher brackets of income and thus they will be able to check evasion with greater efficiency.'[52]

In the 1960s, the Jan Sangh essentially stood for a mixed economy, rejecting both capitalism and communism. As an economic resolution adopted by the party in 1965 noted, 'The capitalist system of economy which accepts the "economic man" as the central point of all its activities is inadequate. The selfish desire to acquire more and more profit is the motivating force in this